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FROM TOKYO TO FOREIGN OFFICE



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Sir E. Benning

No. 1769

13th December 1951

D: 4.45 a.m. 14th December 1951

R: 5.00 a.m. 14th December 1951

EMERGENCY

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Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No. 1769 of 13th December

Repeated for information to Washington

See my immediately preceding telegram.

It looks as if the Americans are going to go ahead with this whether we like it or not. The Japanese certainly will not like it but they may well give in under pressure. I warned Dulles that if they give in Yoshida will let it be known that he was coerced and that I thought this would jeopardise the prospect that Japan would cooperate willingly with us in the future which is what we both want. But he merely said it was idle for Japan to suppose she would be fully independent when the Treaty came into force. I said that might be so but if she was not allowed even the appearance of sovereignty then I thought we should have trouble.

2. It seems to me that there are two courses open to us. The first would be to refuse even to discuss Dulles' proposal, and to say that while we will not actively advise the Japanese to reject it we must make them aware that we are no party to it, and that it is in our view a matter entirely between the United States and Japan. This is likely to create an Anglo-American breach which we are told the Americans are so anxious to avoid and the Japanese to profit by it.

3. The second course would be to examine the United States proposal seriously to see whether our own wits can devise a

/formula which

14 DEC 1951

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Tokyo telegram No. 1769 to Foreign Office



formula which will enable Japan to make peace with Chiang Kai-shek without irrevocably prejudicing her future relations with China. We could still decline to associate ourselves with such a [? gp omitted] vis-à-vis the Japanese but we might reduce the amount of harm the Americans appear intent upon doing. I do not know whether this is a possibility.

4. I suppose there might be a third course and that would be to persuade the Americans to drop the whole thing. But that would I think have to be done in Washington. All my earlier fears about the intentions of Dulles and the Senators appear amply justified and unless the brake is put on from higher up they are going to have their way. Dulles continues to deny in public that he is putting any pressure on the Japanese. But that he is doing so will remain no secret.

5. Dulles goes to Korea on Saturday and will not be available again till 17th December and time is therefore short. I shall be grateful for early instructions.

Foreign Office please pass to Washington as my telegram No. 108.

[Repeated to Washington]

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QQQ

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